

Use a previous report as a template

Activity · Prompting techniques · ~10 min

Before you start

- ☐ You've worked through the earlier prompting activities
- ☐ You have a previous report (PDF) you're satisfied with and would like to reproduce for a new period

Why this matters

Sometimes the easiest way to brief the AI is not to describe what you want — it's to **show** it. Uploading a prior report as a reference lets the AI match the structure, tone, and depth of an existing output rather than reinventing the format.

When to use this approach

- You have a previous report you trust and want to replicate
- You want to keep a consistent format across time periods
- You don't have a custom prompt available for this report type

Steps

1. Upload the report to your Assets

From the main page, go to **Assets** → **Upload assets** → select your PDF.

2. Include the report in the AI conversation

Open a fresh AI conversation. Click the **three-dot menu** → **Include file** → select the report you just uploaded.

The AI now has the PDF as context for everything in this conversation.

3. Ask the AI to replicate the structure

A starter prompt:

Use this report as a template. Create a similar report covering [time period] for [country/region/scope].

Tips

Verify, don't trust. Even when given a template, the AI can drift — it may simplify a chart, drop a section, or summarise loosely. Walk through the output side-by-side with the template before sharing.

Save your "good" examples. As your team produces reports you're proud of, save them to Assets. Each one becomes a template you (or a colleague) can reuse.

What could go wrong

- **AI doesn't seem to "see" the file** — re-check that you included it in the conversation (not just uploaded it). The three-dot menu must show the file as attached.
- **Output skips sections from the template** — ask the AI explicitly: *"Include all the sections from the template, in the same order."*
- **PDF is too large to upload** — split it into chapters, or extract the relevant pages first.

What's next

This finishes the prompting techniques module. From here you'll move into using these skills in real workshop activities — building visualisations, slide decks, and disruption reports with the AI as your collaborator.